

Himalayan Meet of Astronomers – III

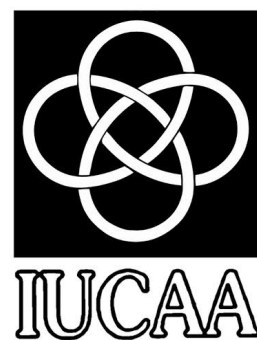
(HMA-III 2026)

1–3 May 2026



Organised by
Department of Physics
Himachal Pradesh University
Summerhill, Shimla–171005
(NAAC Accredited 'A' Grade University)

(Venue: Seminar Hall, Department of Physics)



Sponsored by
Inter-University Centre for Astronomy
and Astrophysics
IUCAA, Pune



Scan to Register

Registration & Abstract Submission Deadline: 15th April, 2026

Registration link: <https://forms.gle/X2AsT2t6ecrhk1g8A>

Contact: meetinghma3hpu26@gmail.com

About Meeting

The Himalayan Meet of Astronomers (HMA-III), scheduled to be held at Department of Physics Himachal Pradesh University Shimla from 1–3 May 2026, aims to promote collaboration and strengthen research in Astronomy and Astrophysics among Ph.D. scholars, postdoctoral researchers, and faculty members from Colleges/Universities. This event will provide a valuable platform for young researchers to present their work, receive constructive feedback from experts, and develop professional networks to strengthen astronomical research across Himalayan region, particularly Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Jammu & Kashmir and neighbouring regions (Punjab, Haryana). Researchers from the Himalayan and neighbouring regions are actively contributing to diverse areas of astronomy and astrophysics. The meeting seeks to bring together motivated students, researchers, and faculty members working in, or intending to pursue, research in related fields, fostering interaction, exchange of ideas, and meaningful scientific collaborations.

About the University

Himachal Pradesh University was established by an Act of the Legislative Assembly of Himachal Pradesh on 22nd July, 1970 as a response to the needs and aspirations of the Union Territory, poised for full statehood in the Union of India on 25th January, 1971. It is the only multi-faculty residential and affiliating university in the State that provides higher education to urban, rural and tribal areas through formal and distant modes. The headquarters of the University is located at Summer Hill, the picturesque suburb of Shimla. The University is surrounded by stately buildings set among rhododendron, silver oak, pine and deodar trees. It affords a salubrious climate and congenial atmosphere for reflection, study and research. The prime objective of the University is to disseminate knowledge, advance learning and understanding through research, training and extension programmes. It instills in its students and teachers a conscious awareness regarding the social and economic needs, cultural ethos, and future requirements of the state and the country.

About the Department

Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University was established in the year 1969 as part of the Regional Centre of Punjab University, Chandigarh. Later with the establishment of Himachal Pradesh University in 1970, it came into existence as a full-fledged State University Department. Since then it is one of the prestigious Post Graduate Department in the state of Himachal Pradesh offering courses leading to M.Sc. in Physics, and a research programme leading to Ph.D. in Physics. The faculty members are well known and recognized for their research contributions in various fields.

About IUCAA

The Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics (IUCAA) is an autonomous institution set up by the University Grants Commission (UGC) of India to promote the nucleation and growth of active groups in astronomy and astrophysics at Indian universities. IUCAA aims to be a centre of excellence within the university sector for teaching, research and development in astronomy and astrophysics. IUCAA's activities fall under two broad programmes: core academic programmes and visitor academic programmes. Core academic programmes include basic research, the PhD programme, advanced research workshops and schools, the giant metre-wave radio telescope and guest observer programmes. Visitor academic programmes include the visitor and associates programme, refresher courses for teachers and helping the nucleation and growth of astronomy and astrophysics at Indian universities.

Scientific Theme

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|---|--|---|
| 1. The Sun, Solar System, and Exoplanets | 3. Extragalactic Astronomy | 5. Gravity, Cosmology, and fundamental physics |
| 2. Stars, Inter Stellar Matter, and the Milky Way | 4. High energy astrophysics, Compact Stars, Nuclear Astrophysics | 6. Time-domain astronomy, surveys, and facilities |

Call for Papers

Original research papers and abstracts for presentation (in oral) are invited from young and highly motivated students, research scholars, postdoctoral fellows, and college/university faculty members from the Himalayan and neighboring regions. The abstract should not exceed 300 words. It should be made in MS Word (.doc/.docx) format, in Times New Roman, 12-point font, with single line spacing. Figures, tables, references, and footnotes should not be included in the abstract. Submissions are accepted via email to meetinghma3hpu26@gmail.com.

Accommodation

Limited accommodation for outside participants shall be made available in the University Guest House/Hostels. Nearby Hotels may be booked directly. Travel support may be provided on request as per the rules.

Organizing Committee

Chief Patron

Prof. Mahavir Singh
Hon'ble Vice-Chancellor
Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla-171005

Patron / Chairperson

Prof. Shashi K. Dhiman
(Founder & Former Hon'ble Vice-Chancellor)
(Himachal Pradesh Technical University, Hamirpur, India)
Department of Physics
Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla-171005

IUCAA Coordinator

Dr. Anupam Bhardwaj
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Local Coordinators

Dr. Raj Kumar Jagota

(Assistant Professor)

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Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla

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Dr. Balbir Singh Patial

(Assistant Professor)

Department of Physics,

Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla

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Scientific Organizing Committee (SOC)

- Prof. Nainjeet Singh Negi, *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Prof. Vir Singh Rangra *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Prof. Nagesh K. Thakur *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Prof. Raman Sharma *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Prof. Hum Chand *Department of Physics and Astronomical Sciences, Central University of Himachal Pradesh (CUHP), Dharamshala*
- Dr. Anupam Bhardwaj *Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics, (IUCAA) Pune*

Local Organizing Committee (LOC)

- Dr. Amarjeet Singh *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Dr. Balbir Singh Patial *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Dr. Dheeraj Sharma *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Dr. Raj Kumar Jagota *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*
- Dr. Indu Sharma *Department of Physics, Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla*